Aditi Bhowmick

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EDUCATION

Harvard University — Cambridge, MA
Ph.D., Public Policy (Economics Track) — August 2023 – Present
Primary Fields: Development Economics, Labor Economics
James M. and Cathleen D. Stone PhD Scholar in Inequality and Wealth Concentration

Princeton University — Princeton, NJ
Masters in Public Administration (Economics) — 2018 – 2020

Cornell University — Ithaca, NY
B.A. in Economics and Political Science — 2012 – 2016

PUBLICATIONS

- "In-group bias in the Indian judiciary: Evidence from 5 million criminal cases"
  With Elliott Ash, Sam Asher, Sandeep Bhupatiraju, Daniel Chen, Tanaya Devi, Christoph Goessmann, Paul Novosad and Bilal Siddiqi. **The Review of Economics and Statistics, 2025.** Link.
- "Excess mortality in India from June 2020 to June 2021 during the COVID pandemic: Death registration, health facility deaths, and survey data"
  With Yashwant Deshmukh, Wilson Suraweera, Chinmay Tumbe, Sankalp Sharma, Paul Novosad, Sze Hang Fu, Leslie Newcombe, Hellen Gelband, Patrick Brown and Prabhat Jha. **Science, 2022:** Link
- "English proficiency, Gender and the Occupations of childhood immigrants in the US"
  With Alicia Adsera. **Journal of Labor Research, 2022:** Link

WORKING PAPERS

- "Productivity Shocks in a Social Context: Divergent Gender Effects of Rural Electrification in India"
  Working paper, 2026. *Revise and Resubmit at World Development.*
- "Cultural Capital and Access to Opportunity in India"
  With Sam Asher, Vidisha Mehta, Paul Novosad, and Maurizio Bussolo. **Working paper, 2025.** Link.
- "The Female Urban Mobility Advantage in South Asia"
  With Sam Asher, Maurizio Bussolo, Jonah Rexner, Paul Novosad, and Sara Sethia. **Working paper, 2025.** Link.

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

- "Social Norms: The Invisible Inputs and Outputs of Development Policy"
  With Eliana La Ferrara. **HKS CID Development Reimagined:** Link
- "Big, Open Data for Development: A Vision for India"
  With Sam Asher, Alison Campion, Tobias Lunt and Paul Novosad. **India Policy Forum, 2021:** Link
- "Expanding Opportunities: A Map for Equitable Growth in South Asia"
  Joint work with the World Bank South Asia Chief Economist's Office, 2023. Link.
- "Effects of COVID-19 on Rural Households in India"
  Joint work with ID Insight and the World Bank, 2020. Link.

CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

LEAP 10th Anniversary Conference. University of Bocconi. 2026
Northeastern Universities Development Consortium. Northeastern University. 2024
Cornell Conference on Development Economics and Law. Cornell University. 2024
5th Society for Gender and Family Economics Meeting. Insper, Brazil. 2024
Pacific Conference for Development Economics. CEGA & University of San Francisco. 2022
Applied Development Economics Conference. Lahore School of Economics. 2021
Discrimination and Diversity Workshop. University of East Anglia. 2021
Winter School. Delhi School of Economics. 2020

RESEARCH GRANTS

Weatherhead Small Research Grant: 2025–2026
With Eliana La Ferrara.
HKS Women and Public Policy Program Research Grant: 2026
With Eliana La Ferrara.
Stone Inequality Fellowship Research Grants (10,000 USD) 2025 and 2026
JPAL Gender and Economic Agency Full RCT Grant (36,335 USD) 2025
HKS Women and Public Policy Program Summer Research Grant (7,000 USD) 2025
Rohini Nilekani Philanthropies Learning Grant (30,000 USD) 2024–2025
IHS Humane Studies Fellowship Grant (3000 USD) 2024–2025
Harvard Mind Brain Behavior Interdisciplinary Grant (10,000 USD) 2024–2025
Center for International Development GEM Incubation Fund: 2024–2025
With Eliana La Ferrara. Mittal Institute Faculty Climate Research Grant: 2024–2025
With Eliana La Ferrara. STEG Large Research Grant: 2021–2023
With Sam Asher, Rebecca Cai and Paul Novosad.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer: *The Quarterly Journal of Economics, The Review of Economics and Statistics, The Economic Journal*
Coordinator: *Harvard Development Economics Graduate Workshop, 2025-2026*
PhD Student Ambassador: *The Center for International Development, 2024-2025*
Mental Health Chair: *Kennedy School PhD Student Association, 2024-2025*

AFFILIATIONS

PhD Affiliate: *Center for International Development at Harvard Kennedy; LEAP at Bocconi University*

TEACHING

DEV 102M: Using Analytical Frameworks for Smart Policy Design *(Graduate)* Spring 2026, 2025
DEV 101: Economic Development Theory and Evidence *(Graduate)* Fall 2026
DEV 102M: Distinction in Student Teaching Award Spring 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

World Bank SARCE, Washington DC & New Delhi (India) 2022–2023

Development Data Lab, Washington DC & New Delhi (India) 2020–2023
India Director (2021–2023); Predoctoral Research Associate (2020–2021)

Evidence Action, J-PAL South Asia 2019, 2016–2018

OTHER

Citizenship: India. *Birthplace:* Jamshedpur, Jharkhand. *Languages:* English, Hindi, Bengali.
Interests: Hindustani Classical Music.